



Lesson plan: Spot the Scam

The activities in this resource aim to help children learn about the different types of scams both offline and online. They identify ways they can protect themselves, family, friends and their community.

This resource embeds e-safety education into teaching and learning in Personal Development and Mutual Understanding. There are opportunities within this resource to connect learning across other areas of the curriculum, such as The Arts, Language and Literacy and Physical Education.

Curriculum Links

Area of Learning: Personal Development and Mutual Understanding

Statutory Requirement: Personal Understanding and Health – to sustain pupil health, growth and well-being and coping safely and efficiently with their environment.

The Levels of Progression for Using ICT include this statement:

Pupils should demonstrate, when and where appropriate, knowledge and understanding of e-safety, including acceptable online behaviour.

Focus for Thinking Skills and Personal Capabilities

Managing Information – classify, compare and evaluate information.

Thinking, Problem Solving and Decision Making – examine evidence and make links between possible causes and effects.

Learning Intentions

We are learning:

- That there are dangers online and offline;
- How to recognise some of the dangers online and offline;
- That there are consequences of sharing personal details; and
- Strategies to stay safe online and offline.

Keywords: scam, fraud and phishing



Activity 1: What is a Scam?

Setup an online collaborative whiteboard such as Google Jamboard or Padlet and invite the children to contribute what they know or understand about scams. Show slide 2 from the **Spot the Scam** presentation. Encourage the children to use words and images. Use the whiteboard to discuss some of their contributions.

Show slide 3 and share the following definition of a scam:

Scams are when criminals use lies and deceit to fool people into parting with personal details with the aim of stealing their money.

This can happen online, by letter, over the phone or on the doorstep.

Examples of scams include:

- When someone tricks you into giving them something of yours;
- Paying for something you never receive; or
- Criminals taking control of your private information to access your online accounts.

Compare and contrast this definition with the ideas the pupils generated.

Next, ask: ***Is there anything that surprises us about the definition or examples?***

Show slide 4 and ask the children to list examples of different types of personal information such as:

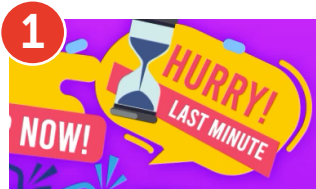
- | | |
|--------------------|---|
| • Photos | • Email address (or parents' email addresses) |
| • Full name | • Passwords |
| • Age | • Where they go to school or after school |
| • Date of birth | • Parents' full names |
| • Address | • Where their parents' work |
| • Telephone number | • Parents' credit/debit card or bank account number |

Discuss why it is important to keep personal details **private, and never give them to people you don't know**. Personal details are often used to set up accounts and need to be kept private. Explain that criminals who carry out scams rely on this information to access people's accounts and money.

Show slide 5. Share the animation **Resource 1: Can you Spot a Scam?** to summarise what a scam is and introduce the **4 SCAM Test Rules**. Using slide 6, discuss the **4 SCAM Test Rules** and how to spot a scam.

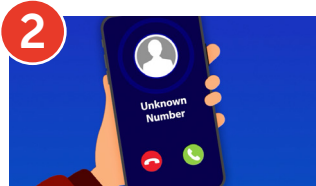


4 SCAM Test Rules



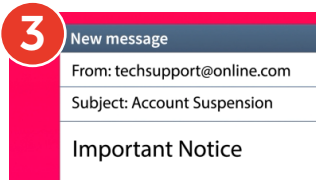
1 Seems too good to be true

Scammers often make false promises, like a last-minute chance to buy products, invest your money or receive free items. Take your time. If it seems too good to be true, it probably is.



2 Contacted out of the blue

Receive an unexpected call, email, text message or letter? Think: could this be fake? It's ok to challenge or refuse a request. Look up the organisation and get in touch directly.



3 Asked for personal details

A phishing scam uses emails or text messages to lure you in. Phishing messages may look like they come from a big brand, bank or government office, but they are fake. No genuine organisation will ask for your personal information by email or text message.



4 Money is requested

Scammers often ask for payment for a 'free' gift, administration fee or sign-up promotion. If it **sounds** dodgy, it probably is.



Activity 2: Scam Case Studies

Show slide 7. In small groups, ask the children to complete **Resource 2: Scam Case Studies**. Discuss how the victim might have felt in each scenario. Ask the children what words they would use to describe how the victim felt? (robbed, cheated, lied to). Ask the groups to decide which of the **4 SCAM Test Rules** could have helped the victim identify and possibly stop the scam.

Activity 3: Safe or a Scam?

Show slide 8. Working in small groups, ask the children to complete **Resource 3: Safe or a Scam?** This interactive quiz includes a series of examples of the main types of scams with a focus on online and gaming scams, relevant to the children's age and hobbies. Children must decide if the example is safe or a scam.

Discuss how easy or difficult the children found the quiz. Talk about the reasons we are likely to be deceived by a scam. For example:

- The promise of a prize, money or a discount;
- The worry of losing photos, games or access to their account;
- Feeling forced to act quickly, before it's too late; and
- Wanting to know more.

As a class, discuss how the **4 SCAM Test Rules** could be applied to each example to avoid a scam. Encourage the children to share the grown-ups quiz scenarios with their families or guardians.

Activity 4: Pause and Reflect

Show slide 9. Return to the interactive whiteboard from the beginning of the activity. Ask the children to use a different coloured font and add any new ideas or information they have learned since **Activity 1: What is a Scam?**

Activity 5: Spread the News

Show slide 10. The activities in **Resource 4: Spread the News** provide opportunities for connected learning across the curriculum. Encourage the children, in their groups, to choose from the variety of options how they can spread the news about the **4 SCAM Test Rules** to their friends and family or the wider community. Show slide 11. Talk about and send home **Resource 5: Family tips – How to Stop a Scam**.

Activity 6: Exit Ticket

Show slide 12 and **Resource 6: Exit Ticket**. Ask the children to complete one ticket. Encourage the children to keep this as a reminder of their learning. The tickets include these prompts:

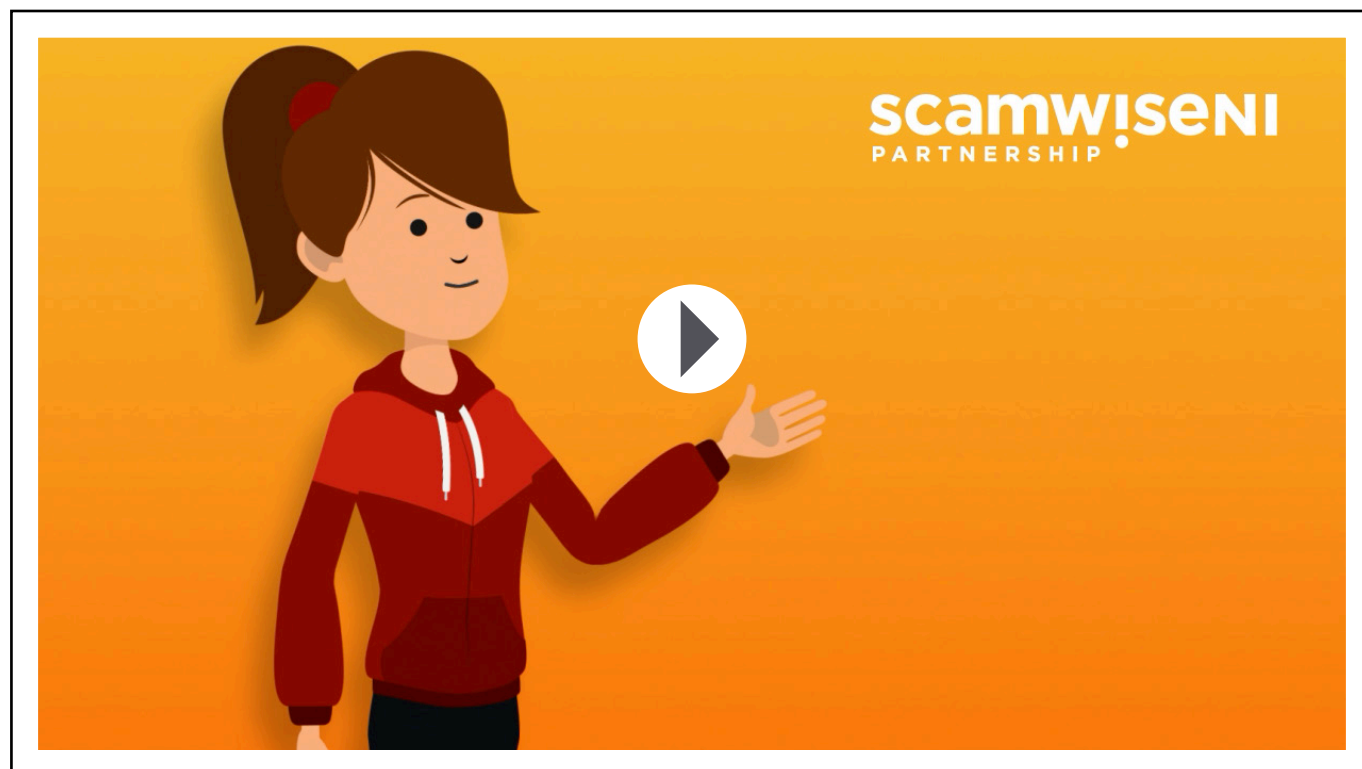
- The **4 SCAM Test Rules** are important to me because ...
- From now on I will try to ...
- I have learned to ...
- I should ...
- I realise that ...

Show slide 13. When the children have completed these activities, present them with **Resource 7: Scamwise Champion Badge**. Encourage the children to take this home, cut out the badge and place it somewhere the whole family can see.



Resource 1: Can you Spot a Scam?

www.ccea.org.uk/scamwise





Resource 2: Scam Case Studies

Scenario 1

Amina can't wait to see her favourite YouTuber live at the arena. The tickets from the official website were sold out but she found another website selling them online. Amina had never heard of this website and there only seemed to be a few left. Amina decided this was too good an offer to miss. She used all her savings and birthday money to buy two tickets, one for her and one for her best friend. The tickets arrived in the post. Amina and her friend went to the venue on the day of the concert, but they weren't allowed in because their tickets were fake.

- How do you think Amina might have felt?
- What words would you use to describe how she felt?
- Which of the **4 SCAM Test Rules** could have helped Amina identify the scam?

Scenario 2

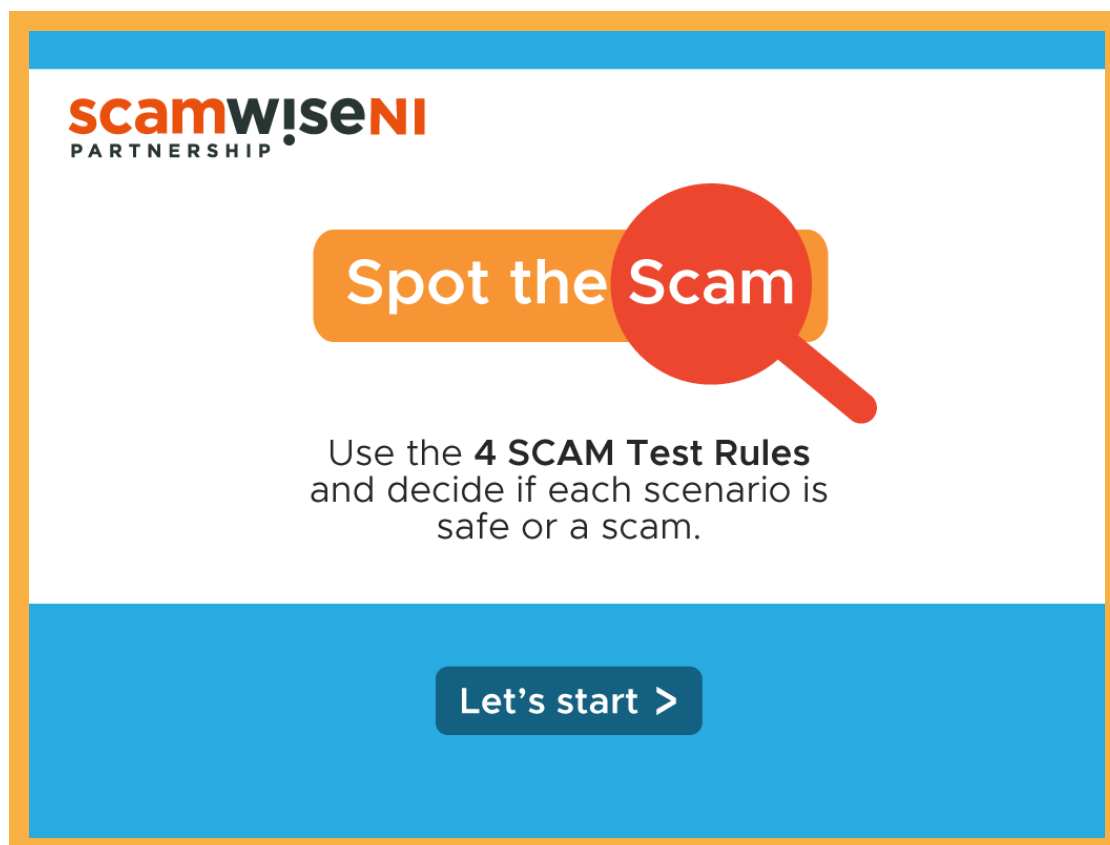
Kieran got a pop-up ad offering a designer hoody worth £300 for only £25. The website was unfamiliar and there were some spelling mistakes on the web page. There were only a few reviews, which weren't great, **but** the clock was ticking as the sale ended at midnight. Kieran convinced his big brother to buy the hoody for him. But it never arrived. He tried the website again, but the link no longer worked.

- How you think Kieran and his brother might have felt?
- What words would you use to describe how they felt?
- Which of the **4 SCAM Test Rules** could have helped Kieran and his brother identify the scam?



Resource 3: Safe or a Scam?

Go to www.ccea.org.uk/scamwise choose KS2 and Spot the Scam resources





Resource 4: Spread the News

Presentation

Using items found in nature, make the **4 SCAM Test Rules** into key messages. Turn this into an animated GIF or similar presentation.

Podcast

Tell a story about the **4 SCAM Test Rules** using your voice and sound effects. Combine with narration to take listeners into your imagination.

News broadcast

Create a news broadcast about one of the scenarios in this resource. Plan and record your news piece. Think about who was involved, what happened and how the **4 SCAM Test Rules** can help to stop a scam.

Create a logo

Create a logo for the **4 SCAM Test Rules**. Use shapes, text and drawing.

Create a rap

Produce a rap song. Write rhymes about the **4 SCAM Test Rules**. Build a beat and bring it all together.

Dance gesture

Make a jump-cut dance video with classmates about the **4 SCAM Test Rules**. Sequence gestures and simple moves like hand movements and swinging hips and record the dance.

Go outdoors

Get outdoors and arrange rocks or leaves into a phrase about the **4 SCAM Test Rules**. Take a photo from an interesting angle.

Write a collaborative story

Work with classmates on a collaborative story about a scam. Each writer takes turns adding to the story in different font colours. Leave a cliff-hanger for the next writer until the story is completed.

Translate the message

Create a short video saying the steps of the **4 SCAM Test Rules** in various languages. Use a translation tool to learn the words. Add text, emoji, or other effects to your video to emphasise the message.

Create a video clip

Create a video clip based on one of the scenarios in this resource. Write your screenplay, get your actors in place and record your video clip.

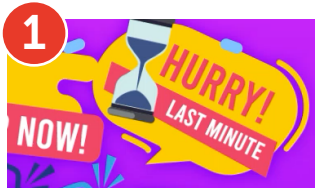
Telling the tale

Create a comic strip detailing a scam scenario between a consumer and a scammer. Choose the method and type of scam. Use visuals and captions to illustrate the events.



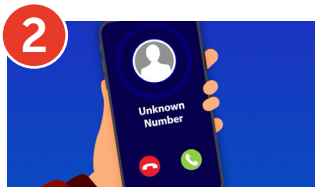
Resource 5: Family Tips – How to Stop a Scam

Seems too good to be true? Contacted out of the blue? Use the **4 SCAM Test Rules** to spot a scam and stop a scam:



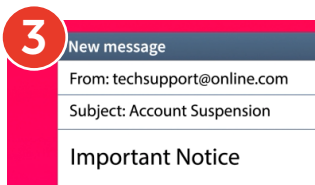
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4 Money is requested

Scammers often ask for payment for a 'free' gift, administration fee or sign-up promotion. If it sounds dodgy, it probably is.

If a scammer tries to contact you, you can report it to **Action Fraud on 0300 123 2040** or to the **PSNI on 101**. Always report bogus callers to the PSNI.

We all have a part to play in the fight against scams. Share these tips to help protect your family and friends. Remember, if you can spot a scam, you can stop a scam. For more help and information visit: www.ccea.org.uk/scamwise



Resource 6: Exit Tickets

The **4 SCAM Test Rules** are important to me because ...

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I have learned to ...

I should ...

I realise that ...



Resource 7: Scamwise Champion Badge

Congratulations! You're a Scamwise Champion!

Cut out and keep this badge where your whole family can see it!

